

Production Spec — Reference Ad Teardown

Reference ad: Chicnutrix "Glow Advanced" — influencer/UGC performance ad **Public link:** [PASTE PUBLIC URL HERE BEFORE SUBMITTING] **Runtime:** 45.6 s · 720×1280 (9:16 vertical) · 30 fps · 17 shots **Analysed by:** frame-accurate scene-cut detection (threshold 0.25) + shot-by-shot frame extraction

1. What kind of video this is

A 45-second vertical direct-response ad for an ingestible beauty supplement, built as a **single-presenter confessional** — one woman talks straight to camera for the whole runtime while B-roll and product footage cut in over her voice. It opens on a 8-second contrarian hook (*"The worst thing Instagram ever did was convince me that every skin problem needed a different product"*) that attacks the category before it sells anything.

The job it does for the brand: **reframe the buyer's problem so the product becomes the obvious answer.** It is not an awareness film. It argues that a shelf full of topical products is the wrong solution, then positions one ingestible as the replacement — and closes on a time-bound proof claim ("in 6 weeks* only") designed to drive a click, not a feeling.

2. How it's shot and why

Choice	Why it works
Single fixed medium shot, waist-up, eye-level for every A-roll beat	Costs nothing to shoot, and the unchanging frame makes the presenter feel like a person talking to you rather than an ad. Stability is also what lets 6 separate A-roll segments cut together as one continuous conversation.
Same room, same outfit, same lighting for 100% of A-roll	The ad cuts away 10 times. Every return to the presenter must feel like <i>no time has passed</i> — one wardrobe and one setup is what buys that.
Soft warm key from frame-left, visible palm-frond shadow on a beige wall	Reads as "someone's apartment in the afternoon," not a studio. The shadow is doing heavy lifting: it's a fixed, recognisable background feature that proves continuity across every cutback.
Extreme close-up B-roll of real skin texture (pigmentation, breakouts, pores)	The problem has to look real and unretouched, or the promise is not credible. These are the only shots in the ad that are deliberately unflattering.
Fast cutting through the problem list — 4 shots in 4.2 seconds (6.7 s → 10.8 s)	The cutting rate <i>is</i> the argument. Each rapid cut is one more product you supposedly need; the edit makes the category feel exhausting before the script says so.
Cutting slows to 3-4.7 s per shot after the product appears	Pace drop signals relief. The problem section is frantic; the solution section breathes.
CG liposome renders (28.9 s → 36.8 s, 7.9 s total — the longest single block)	Supplements can't show results in action, so abstract science imagery substitutes for proof. It also buys the ad its most "premium" visual without a production budget.
Kinetic caption on every single frame, mixed serif-italic and sans	Built for sound-off autoplay. The italic serif carries the emotional words, the sans carries the claims — so the hierarchy survives even as a thumbnail.

Choice	Why it works
Before/after split at 39.2 s, held only 1.7 s	Placed late, after credibility is built, and held short — long enough to register, short enough not to invite scrutiny.
3.4-second logo-only end card	Standard performance-ad practice: brand last, once the argument has landed.

3. Shot-by-shot breakdown

Structure: Hook 0.00–8.10 (8.1 s) · Mid 8.10–42.23 (34.1 s) · CTA 42.23–45.59 (3.4 s) **Shot mix:** 6 A-roll segments · 10 B-roll/CG inserts · 1 end card

#	In - Out	Dur	Type	What's in frame	What happens
1	0.00 – 6.67	6.67	A-roll	MS presenter, pink dress, beige wall, white facial roller in hand	Full hook line delivered to camera; gestures with roller
2	6.67 – 8.10	1.43	B-roll	ECU cheek, visible pigmentation	"a cream for pigmentation"
3	8.10 – 9.77	1.67	B-roll	ECU neck / jawline	"a serum for hydration"
4	9.77 – 9.90	0.13	A-roll	MS presenter	Single-frame flash cutback — rhythmic punctuation
5	9.90 – 10.83	0.93	B-roll	ECU under-eye, finger touching skin	"a treatment for breakouts"
6	10.83 – 12.43	1.60	B-roll	CU green clay mask, gua-sha tool	"a mask for dullness"
7	12.43 – 15.77	3.34	A-roll	MS presenter	"and somehow..." — pace resets, turn into the pitch
8	15.77 – 18.80	3.03	Product	3 tubes on plinth, brand lockup	Product reveal, name on screen
9	18.80 – 23.07	4.27	B-roll	Effervescent tablet dropping into water glass	Hero ingredient named on screen
10	23.07 – 25.30	2.23	B-roll	CU presenter drinking through straw	"antioxidant" — shows the ritual
11	25.30 – 28.90	3.60	A-roll	MS presenter	"to slow signs of..."
12	28.90 – 33.57	4.67	CG	Liposome spheres, iridescent	Delivery-technology claim
13	33.57 – 36.83	3.26	CG	Bubbles inside membrane	"for faster absorption and impact"
14	36.83 – 39.17	2.34	A-roll	MS presenter	"11 more skin-lovin' ingredients"
15	39.17 – 40.83	1.66	B-roll	Before/after split, same face	"Get visible results"

#	In - Out	Dur	Type	What's in frame	What happens
16	40.83 - 42.23	1.40	A-roll	MS presenter	"In 6 weeks* only"
17	42.23 - 45.59	3.36	CTA	Logo end card on cream	Brand lockup + tagline

4. What must never change

These are locked. Any future video in this series that breaks one of them stops feeling like part of the same family.

Character - One presenter, female, mid-20s, South Asian, shoulder-length dark hair worn down - Same face across every A-roll shot — this is the single hardest constraint and the first thing a viewer notices when it breaks - One outfit per video, saturated single-colour, spaghetti-strap — never patterned - Delivers to lens, never to an off-camera interviewer

Environment - One room per video, shot from one camera position for all A-roll - Warm beige / sand wall, visibly textured, never pure white - Hard plant-shadow cast frame-left — the continuity anchor - Nothing in frame changes position between cutbacks

Look - Warm palette only: beige, sand, terracotta, skin tones, plus one saturated accent (here, magenta) carried by wardrobe - Soft directional key from frame-left, no hard shadow on the face, one lighting logic for the whole video - 9:16, 720×1280 minimum, 30 fps

Structure - Hook 8–10 s, single unbroken A-roll, no cut inside it - CTA 3–4 s, logo-only, no presenter - Mid-section beats never exceed 10 s - Captions on 100% of frames — the ad must work muted

Tone - First person, conversational, mild contrarian irritation — never bubbly, never clinical - The problem is named before the product appears - One time-bound claim near the end, asterisked

5. Three questions for the client

1. **Where does this run — Meta Reels, YouTube pre-roll, or Amazon PDP?** Reels can carry an 8-second hook before the payoff; a skippable YouTube pre-roll needs the product visible before 0:05, which would restructure the entire first third.
2. **What claims has your regulatory/legal team already cleared, and what does the "6 weeks*" asterisk resolve to?** The whole ad is built on a time-bound efficacy claim. If that number isn't substantiated for this market, the script's spine changes, not just its wording.
3. **Is this presenter a contracted brand face for the series, or one of a rotating cast?** A locked face means we build a reusable character reference set and every future video inherits it; a rotating cast means consistency lives in the room and the grade instead, which is a different build.